

THE PURSUIT OF SUCCESS

AFTER THREE FAILED ventures, Vineeta Singh, Co-founder of SUGAR Cosmetics, has carved a unique path in India's beauty industry. Singh tells *BT* that the brand's omnichannel strategy has positioned it among the Top 3 cosmetics firms in India. However, her entrepreneurial journey has been far from smooth.

At 23, Singh turned down a job offer from a multinational bank with a salary of ₹1 crore, because she wanted to become an entrepreneur, looking to launch a lingerie brand. But funding issues brought that to an end.

After a couple of more

failed ventures, Singh and husband Kaushik Mukherjee launched SUGAR Cosmetics in 2015, which quickly found its footing and has since become a top cosmetics brand.

Since its inception, SUGAR has witnessed significant growth. Singh says the company's revenue surpassed ₹500 crore in FY23 from just ₹3 crore in FY17, achieving a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 60% over the past three years. She credits that to SUGAR's omnichannel distribution strategy, which has helped secure a presence in over 45,000 retail outlets across 550 cities



PHOTO BY YASIR IQBAL

VINEETA SINGH

41, Co-founder and CEO, SUGAR Cosmetics

in India, and helped expand into international markets like the UAE, Russia, and Nepal.

Currently, SUGAR Cosmetics is navigating its transition from a venture capital-funded start-up to a profitable business. Singh says the focus is on narrowing

the gap with leading competitors and expanding the company's Korean skincare brand, Quench Botanics, launched in collaboration with Bollywood star Kareena Kapoor Khan. **BT**

— BY PALAK AGARWAL

ADVICE TO YOUR YOUNGER SELF

Be hard on yourself but don't take yourself too seriously

MANTRA TO NAVIGATE CHALLENGES

Feel grateful to have the ability to make a difference

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ZOYA AKHTAR

52, Director and Co-founder, Tiger Baby

PHOTO BY MILIND SHELTE

WITHOUT A SCRIPT

ZOYA AKHTAR WEARS many hats. She is a writer, director, producer, and Co-founder of production house Tiger Baby along with Director Reema Kagti. The duo also launched an audio label last year, Tiger Baby Records, in partnership with musician Ankur Tewari. She is among the most sought after directors in India thanks to hits like *Gully Boy* (2019). After producing critically acclaimed TV series, like *Made In Heaven*, and the popular

documentary *Angry Young Men*, she now wants to go off script with unscripted storytelling, including a nature documentary *Turtle Walker* and *In Transit*, a series that follows the lives of nine transgender individuals. That desire to innovate constantly has ensured that Akhtar stays on *BT*'s MPW list for this year. **BT**

— BY RIDDHIMA BHATNAGAR

WHY SHE MATTERS

After setting the pace in the film industry, Zoya Akhtar, through her production house Tiger Baby, is at the forefront of big transformations that are taking place in the Indian video streaming space